Twenty Years of Promises: Where GCC Transport Really Stands

The record a new programme starts from: what the Gulf states promised for transport and mobility since 2006, what actually happened, the shocks that changed course, and the questions that will shape the next decade.

Built from 147 verified sources, 2006 to 2026 (sources before 2011 only where they record when a promise was first made): 43 from governments, regulators, statistics offices and research bodies (Tier 1 and 2), 27 in Arabic. Every source was opened and its date read off the page. Download as PDF

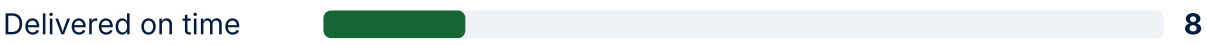
The short version. Of 48 big transport promises whose deadline has passed, 8 arrived on time. 19 arrived late, by a median of 2.6 years. 13 are still not delivered, and 8 were scaled back or abandoned.

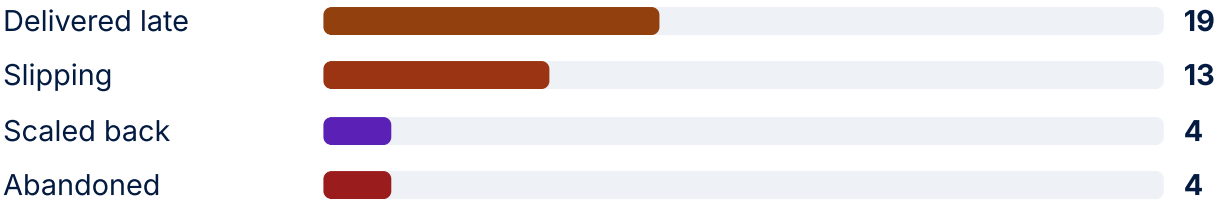
The pattern is steady. Airports, ports and road links usually arrive: 12 of 16 past their date have been delivered, typically about 2 years late, though Abu Dhabi's Midfield Terminal took 13. Rail and metro has the weakest record: of 23 promises past their date, 13 have been delivered and only 3 on time. The rest, mostly cross-border links and metros outside Dubai, Doha and Riyadh, are still waiting or were dropped. The few on-time cases mostly had a date that could not move, such as a Hajj season, a royal order or Dubai's 9 September 2009 opening. Targets for new technology, from driverless trips to air taxis and electric cars, have so far been met only in pilot form. Two shocks did the most damage to timetables: the oil price collapse of 2014 to 2016 and the pandemic of 2020.

The programme uses this record to judge new announcements. When a fresh deadline is set, the first question is how similar promises have fared.

1. How promises have fared

Each promise below was matched with a later source recording what happened. Slips are measured from the first date promised, not from later restatements. Only promises whose deadline has passed are counted in the bars, and forecasts by outside bodies are kept apart.





Counted from the graded promises in this baseline only; a guide to how often GCC transport promises arrive on time, not a statistical sample.

Rail and metro

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Dubai Metro Red Line ready by September 2009	March 2006	2009	Delivered on time	Opened on 9 September 2009 as promised, but with only 10 of its 29 stations; the rest opened in phases through 2010 and later.	Gulf News, 2006; Dubai Media Office, 2024
Al Mashaaer Al Mugaddassah metro open for the November 2010 Hajj at 35% capacity, full capacity for the 2011 Hajj	June 2009	2010	Delivered on time	First trips ran on 13 November 2010 at about 35% capacity, as promised. Full-capacity running is confirmed by the 2012 Hajj; 2011 could not be verified.	Railway Gazette International, 2009; Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2015
First stage of the Doha Metro finished in 2019	November 2013	2019	Delivered on time	The Red Line South opened to the public in May 2019.	The Peninsula, 2013; Gulf Times, 2019

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Dubai Metro Green Line operational by March 2010	March 2006	2010	Delivered late	Delay confirmed in 2009 and the date moved to mid and then late 2010; the 23 km line opened on 9 September 2011 with 16 of 18 stations.	Gulf News, 2006; Dubai Media Office, 2024
Al Sufouh (Dubai) tram first phase in service on 11 April 2011	October 2008	2011	Delivered late	Opened on 11 November 2014 as a 10.6 km line with 11 stations, against 13 stations announced for phase 1 in 2008.	Alstom, 2008; Al Bayan, 2014
Haramain High Speed Railway complete by mid-2012 (later restated as 2014)	March 2009	2012	Delivered late	Slipped to 2014, January 2017, Q1 2018 and Q3 2018. Inaugurated by King Salman on 25 September 2018, about six years after the first target.	Arab News, 2009; Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2018; Argaam, 2018

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Etihad Rail Phase 1 (264 km Shah, Habshan, Ruwais) complete by end 2014, Ruwais to Habshan in early 2013	October 2009	2014	Delivered late	Safety approval for commercial operations on the full 264 km came in December 2015, and Stage One has been fully operational since January 2016.	Al Ittihad, 2009; Etihad Rail, 2023
UAE national railway (Union Railway, now Etihad Rail) for freight and passengers complete by 2017	October 2009	2017	Delivered late	Stage Two tendering was suspended in January 2016 and restarted later; the roughly 900 km freight network was inaugurated on 23 February 2023, and passenger services were set to start on 30 September 2026.	Al Ittihad, 2009; Gulf News, 2026

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
North-South railway passenger services (Riyadh to Al Qassim and Hail) starting in 2014	January 2012	2014	Delivered late	Passenger service to Al Qassim via Majmaah began on 26 February 2017 and reached Hail on 26 November 2017.	MEED, 2012; Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2017
All six Riyadh Metro lines and 85 stations operational in 2019	November 2013	2019	Delivered late	The first three lines opened on 1 December 2024, two more on 15 December 2024 and the last on 5 January 2025, about five to six years late.	MEED, 2013; Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2024
Lusail tram: first line open in 2018 and the other three lines in 2020	June 2014	2020	Delivered late	The first passenger service (six Orange Line stations) began on 1 January 2022, about three years late; the last line, the Turquoise Line, opened in January 2025, with one station still to come.	Railway Gazette International, 2014; Qatar Ministry of Transport, 2025

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Riyadh bus network in commercial operation in Q2 2019	October 2016	2019	Delivered late	Phase 1 (more than 340 buses on 15 of 86 routes) launched on 18 March 2023; further phases followed.	Argaam, 2016; Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2023
Dubai Metro Route 2020 complete in 2019, ahead of Expo 2020	March 2018	2019	Delivered late	Four stations opened 1 January 2021 and the Expo 2020 and Dubai Investment Park stations opened 1 June 2021, before Expo's postponed October 2021 opening.	Gulf Business, 2018; Khaleej Times, 2021

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Etihad Rail passenger services in phases through 2026 and 2027, with Abu Dhabi, Dubai and Fujairah from 30 September 2026	June 2026	2027	On track so far	Abu Dhabi to Fujairah started 30 June 2026 and the Dubai station was inaugurated on 28 September 2026 ahead of the 30 September start. Al Dhafra and Sharjah phases are still to come.	UAE Government Media Office, 2023; Khaleej Times, 2026
First phases of the Abu Dhabi metro and tram running by 2015 (restated in 2013 as 2018)	April 2009	2015	Slipping	The plan was cut from 130 km to 70 km in 2012. Tenders due by the end of 2014 were delayed, and in March 2017 procurement had still not restarted. No construction confirmed since.	Khaleej Times, 2009; MEED, 2017

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
GCC Railway linking all six states complete by 2017 (restated in 2013 as 2018)	December 2010	2017	Slipping	The target moved to 2021, then to December 2030. Only national sections such as Etihad Rail have been built.	Khaleej Times, 2011; Bahrain Ministry of Transportation and Telecommunications, 2026
Oman's first railway operations, Sohar to Muscat, by 2017 (restated in 2015 as Sohar to Buraimi by the end of 2018)	February 2011	2017	Slipping	Suspended in 2016 as oil revenue fell. The Sohar to UAE link was revived as the joint Hafeet Rail project, about 40% built by April 2026 with trials expected in Q4 2027.	Oxford Business Group, 2011; Gulf Daily News, 2026
Saudi Landbridge rail link from Jeddah to Riyadh to Dammam to move ahead from 2012	January 2012	2013	Slipping	Still at the design tender stage in 2025, with completion now set for 2034.	MEED, 2012; Ministry of Transport and Logistic Services (Saudi Arabia), 2021; MEED, 2026

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Jeddah Metro completed by 2020	August 2014	2020	Slipping	Stalled after the 2015 oil price fall; restarted with a Blue Line preliminary design tender in January 2026. No line is built.	Al Arabiya English, 2014; MEED, 2026
Kuwait national railway complete by 2018	February 2015	2018	Slipping	No rail system by 2019; in 2023 phase one covered only feasibility and design consultancy.	MEED, 2015; Oxford Business Group, 2024
Makkah metro Phase 1 (two lines, about 45 km) operating in 2019	April 2015	2019	Slipping	Faltered for more than a decade over funding, land and scope; in May 2026 the Royal Commission only tendered initial design studies.	Oxford Business Group, 2015; MEED, 2026

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
King Hamad Causeway to Saudi Arabia: construction to start in about two years, concession tender documents ready by end 2020	October 2018	2020	Slipping	By December 2024 the $3.5bn causeway was still a planned PPP with its timeline under review and no completion date.	Al Yaum, 2018; Oxford Business Group, 2024
Bahrain Metro phase 1 (29 km, two driverless lines) operating in 2027	December 2020	2027	Slipping	Cabinet approved the PPP tender in October 2021, but by January 2026 no contract had been awarded and no opening date was given; 2027 is no longer achievable.	Middle East Construction News, 2020; Asharq Al-Awsat, 2021; Bahrain Confidential, 2026
Kuwait metro to begin operating by 2020	May 2012	2020	Abandoned	Still in feasibility studies in 2016, delayed by the downturn by 2019, and scrapped in 2023 on financial grounds.	Oxford Business Group, 2012; Oxford Business Group, 2024

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
A Hyperloop One system built in the UAE within five years, with Dubai to Abu Dhabi in about 12 minutes	November 2016	2021	Abandoned	No system was built. Hyperloop One shut down in December 2023, with DP World keeping its intellectual property.	Khaleej Times, 2016; AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight), 2023

Aviation, ports and logistics

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Make the first phase of Khalifa Port at Taweelah (2 million TEU) operational in 2012	March 2010	2012	Delivered on time	Khalifa Port began commercial operations on 1 September 2012, on time and under budget by the operator's account, and was inaugurated on 12 December 2012.	The National, 2010; A Ports Group, 2013

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Expand Madinah's Prince Mohammad bin Abdulaziz Airport through a PPP to handle up to 8 million passengers a year by 2015	January 2012	2015	Delivered on time	The new airport opened to the public in 2015 and was officially opened in early July 2015 with capacity rising to 8 million; COVID later cut traffic by 80% and forced a 2021 restructuring.	International Finance Corporation (IFC), 2(World Bank Blogs (P 2023
Complete the Dubai Water Canal linking Business Bay to the Gulf, about AED 2 billion, by 2017	October 2013	2017	Delivered on time	The 12 km canal was inaugurated in November 2016, ahead of the 2017 date, but at a reported cost of AED 3.7 billion against about AED 2 billion at launch.	Khaleej Times, 2013; Dubai Protocol Department, 2016
Open Abu Dhabi's Midfield Terminal in November 2010 (restated in 2013 as 2017)	July 2007	2010	Delivered late	The terminal, renamed Terminal A, opened at the end of October 2023 and took all flights from 14 November 2023, about 13 years after the first target, with capacity of up to 45m passengers.	Gulf Construction, 2(Travel Extra, 2023

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Finish the first phase of Qatar's New Doha Port (later Hamad Port) in 2014	February 2010	2014	Delivered late	The target moved to early 2016; first-phase operations began in December 2016 and the port was formally inaugurated on 5 September 2017, three months into the blockade of Qatar.	MEED, 2010; Oxford Business Group, 201
Start passenger flights at Al Maktoum International (Dubai World Central) at the end of March 2011	June 2010	2011	Delivered late	Cargo flights began in June 2010 but the passenger terminal (7 million a year) only opened on 27 October 2013.	CAPA Centre for Avia 2010; Dubai Airports 2013
Complete the new Muscat International Airport passenger terminal in the third quarter of 2014	October 2010	2014	Delivered late	The new terminal (12 million passengers a year) opened for all flights on 20 March 2018, about three and a half years after the stated date.	CAPA Centre for Avia 2010; Daily Mirror Business (bizenglish.adaderar Oman Air release, 20

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Build the new King Abdulaziz International Airport terminal in Jeddah (30 million passengers a year) in a three-year project, completing by the end of 2014	November 2010	2014	Delivered late	The first Saudia flight left the new terminal on 29 May 2018 in a phased transfer; the old Southern Terminal closed and operations moved to Terminal 1 by June 2020.	Aviation Week (Time Aerospace), 2010; G News, 2020
Make the upgraded Salalah airport with a new terminal operational around 2014	March 2011	2014	Delivered late	The new Salalah terminal received its first flight on 15 June 2015, about six months after end-2014, at a cost of over 300 million Omani riyals.	Aviation Week (Time Aerospace), 2011; Aviation Week (Route 2015
Hamad International Airport, Doha, to open on 12 December 2012	May 2012	2012	Delivered late	A 1 April 2013 opening was cancelled at the last minute over Civil Defence requirements; partial operations began on 30 April 2014 and full operations on 27 May 2014.	Business Travel New Europe, 2012; Gulf T 2014

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
New Bahrain International Airport terminal complete in 2019	January 2016	2019	Delivered late	Operations moved to the new terminal in January 2021, raising capacity to 14 million passengers a year.	Engineering News-Record (ENR), 2016; Ministry of Transportation and Telecommunications Bahrain, 2025
Sheikh Jaber Al Ahmad (Subiya) Causeway completed in 2018	October 2017	2018	Delivered late	Opened on 1 May 2019, a few months after the stated year. The promise source is from 2017; the 2012 contract award reports gave no completion date.	MEED, 2017; Oxford Business Group, 201
King Salman International Airport to handle up to 120 million travellers by 2030 and 185 million by 2050	November 2022	2030	On track so far	National traffic reached 128 million passengers across all Saudi airports in 2024. The new airport is not yet open; grade provisional.	Public Investment Fu (PIF), 2022; MEED, 2

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Riyadh Air to connect Riyadh to over 100 destinations by 2030	March 2023	2030	On track so far	The first route, a daily Riyadh to London Heathrow service, began on 26 October 2025, with Dubai to follow; reaching 100 destinations in about four years would require very fast growth. Grade is provisional.	Public Investment Fu (PIF), 2023; The Peninsula, 2025
Dubai International to reach 100 million annual passengers by 2027	January 2025	2027	On track so far	DXB handled 92.3 million passengers in 2024, up from 86.4 million in 2019.	Dubai Airports, 2020 Government of Duba Media Office, 2025
Dubai World Central (Al Maktoum International), six runways and 120 million passengers a year, complete by 2017 (relaunched in 2014 as an AED120bn expansion)	September 2007	2017	Slipping	In April 2024 Dubai replaced the plan with an AED128 billion, 260 million passenger terminal whose first phase is expected within 10 years, so the move from DXB slips to the mid-2030s.	Executive Magazine, 2007; Government o Dubai Media Office,

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Qatar-Bahrain Friendship Causeway (40 km, USD3bn): works to start after nine months of studies and finish within 51 months, about 2013	May 2008	2013	Slipping	Never built. On hold from about 2010, frozen by the 2017 rift, revived politically in November 2023, and back at feasibility study stage with a contract awarded in December 2025.	VINCI, 2008; Al Jaze 2023; MEED, 2026
Complete Kuwait International Airport Terminal 2 by November 2016 (restated as 2020)	February 2010	2016	Slipping	In May 2026 contracts were still being signed to complete the final phases of T2, with opening now aimed at the end of 2026, ten years after the first date.	Airport Technology, Al Rai (alraimedia.co 2026

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Start operating Mubarak al-Kabeer port on Bubiyan Island with 2 million TEU capacity in 2016	November 2011	2016	Slipping	The port was still not operating in 2024 to 2025; Kuwait agreed first steps with a Chinese state company in August 2024 and signed a contract in December 2025 with the project at the pre-implementation phase. MEED reported in 2014 that the port had first been due to open in 2010.	MEED, 2011; Al Rai (alraimedia.com), 20 The Maritime Execut 2025
Raise Saudi port capacity to more than 40 million containers a year by 2030	July 2021	2030	Slipping	Throughput was 9.5 million containers in 2020; in 2024 the Red Sea crisis cut King Abdullah Port throughput by over 80% and sharply reduced Jeddah calls. Grade provisional until a national 2024 total is confirmed.	Argaam, 2021; Heller Shipping News (OceanMind analysis 2025

New mobility

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Public launch of Dubai robotaxi service in 2026 after Baidu Apollo Go trials	April 2025	2026	Delivered on time	Commercial driverless taxi service started in Umm Suqeim and Jumeirah on 30 March 2026 with Apollo Go and WeRide; the separate goal of 1,000 taxis within three years is still pending, with 144 vehicles by August 2026.	Gulf News, 2025; Dubai Media Office, 2026
Archer to commercialise electric air taxi operations in the UAE by 2026	October 2023	2026	On track so far	In November 2025 Archer was still flight testing but kept a 2026 launch with Abu Dhabi Aviation, with certification expected in the third quarter of 2026. No passenger service confirmed by October 2026.	Archer Aviation, 2023; Khaleej Times, 2025

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
25% of all trips in Dubai to be autonomous by 2030	April 2016	2030	Slipping	Paid driverless robotaxi service only began in March and April 2026; by August 2026 Dubai had 144 robotaxis, 48 in actual operation, carrying about 50 trips a day, far from a quarter of trips four years before the deadline.	The Peninsula (Associated Press), 2016; Dubai Media Office, 2026
Dubai electric and hybrid cars to reach 2% of cars by 2020 and 10% by 2030	September 2017	2030	Slipping	Dubai had 25,929 electric cars at the end of 2023, and PwC expected electric cars to pass 15% of UAE new sales only by 2030. Adoption is still in the tens of thousands, so the 10% share is slipping.	Dubai Electricity and Water Authority (DEWA), 2017; PwC Middle East, 2024
Ceer electric cars on sale in Saudi Arabia in 2025	November 2022	2025	Slipping	In February 2025 Ceer said the first vehicle would come off the line in late 2026, so sales slipped beyond 2025.	Public Investment Fund (PIF), 2022; AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight), 2025

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Joby air taxi service in Dubai, initial operations as early as 2025 and service by early 2026	February 2024	2026	Slipping	No passenger service in 2025 or early 2026; as of September 2026 the commercial launch is targeted for the end of 2026 after the DXB vertiport was certified in July 2026.	Joby Aviation, 2024; Arabian Business, 2026
30% of cars in Riyadh to be electric by 2030	July 2025	2030	Slipping	Electric cars were just over 1% of Saudi car sales in mid-2025.	CNN, 2025
Personal rapid transit pods to serve all of Masdar City in place of cars, with the city due for completion in 2016	February 2009	2016	Scaled back	By early 2011 the budget was cut and the system stayed a single route, which by 2013 was a half-mile shuttle from a garage to Masdar Institute.	Technology Review (MIT), 2009; Popular Science, 2013
First phase of NEOM, a city served by driverless vehicles and passenger drones, complete by 2025	October 2017	2025	Scaled back	The flagship Line was cut back in 2024 to 2.4 km by 2030, and no first phase was complete by 2025.	Dezeen, 2017; AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight), 2024

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
The Line: a 170 km car-free city for a million people with no trip longer than 20 minutes, construction from early 2021	January 2021	2030	Scaled back	In April 2024 reports said only 2.4 km would be finished by 2030 with fewer than 300,000 residents, against an earlier estimate of 1.5 million.	Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2021; AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight), 2024
EHang 184 autonomous passenger drone to begin regular operations in Dubai in July 2017	February 2017	2017	Abandoned	No regular passenger drone service started; Volocopter flew a test in September 2017, and by September 2026 Dubai's first commercial air taxi service (Joby) was still targeted for the end of 2026.	Engadget, 2017; Arabian Business, 2026
Cruise driverless taxis to operate in Dubai from 2023, rising to 4,000 vehicles by 2030	April 2021	2023	Abandoned	Cruise did not launch commercial service in Dubai, and GM ended Cruise robotaxi development in December 2024; Dubai switched to Baidu Apollo Go and WeRide, which launched in 2026.	Al Etihad, 2021; Dubai Media Office, 2026

Policy and targets

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Allow women to obtain driving licences and drive, with the royal order implemented from 10 Shawwal 1439 (June 2018)	September 2017	2018	Delivered on time	The ban ended on 24 June 2018, the date set, and women drove legally from that day.	Okaz, 2017; Associated Press (via Bangor Daily News), 2018
Raise Saudi Arabia on the World Bank Logistics Performance Index, from 55th to 25th by 2030 (a top-10 aim was set later)	May 2020	2030	On track so far	Saudi Arabia reached 38th in 2023: on course for 25th, well short of the top 10 so far.	Oxford Business Group, 2020; Argaam, 2023
Over 42,000 electric cars on Dubai roads by 2030	July 2023	2030	On track so far	PwC counted 25,929 EVs in Dubai by end-December 2023, about 62% of the target with six years remaining.	Dubai Media Office, 2023; PwC Middle East, 2024
Cut fuel subsidies and move Omani pump prices toward market levels	January 2016	2016	Scaled back	Oman raised prices in January 2016, then capped them at October 2021 rates with the state absorbing losses to end-2022.	Al Arabiya English, 2016; Oman Observer, 2021

PROMISE	MADE	DUE	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Move Saudi gasoline to market-linked prices and eliminate gasoline subsidies	December 2017	2018	Scaled back	Prices rose in December 2015 and January 2018, but a royal directive capped gasoline at 2.18 and 2.33 riyals per litre from July 2021.	Ahram Online, 2015; Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2021

Forecasts, and how they turned out

FORECAST	MADE	FOR	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Dubai International to handle 98.5 million passengers by 2020	May 2011	2020	Forecast missed. Traffic peaked at 86.4 million in 2019, about 12% short of the 2020 forecast, and then fell to 25.9 million in 2020 because of COVID-19. Status is the closest fit for a missed forecast.	Dubai Airports (media centre), 2011; Gulf News, 2021
GCC population to double by 2024 from its 2010 level, driving rail demand	April 2015	2024	Forecast missed. National statistics show the six states grew from about 40 million in 2010 to about 61 million in 2024, roughly 50% growth rather than a doubling; GCC-Stat puts 2024 at 61.5 million. Status is the closest fit for a missed forecast.	Oxford Business Group, 2015; Qatar Tribune (QNA, citing GCC-Stat), 2026
Bahrain to spend $6bn on rail within $79bn of GCC rail spending, 2011 to 2020	November 2011	2020	Bahrain had no metro contract by January 2026 and the causeway rail link was still under review in 2024; little of the forecast Bahraini rail spend took place by 2020.	Railway Technology, 2011; Oxford Business Group, 2024; Bahrain Confidential, 2026

FORECAST	MADE	FOR	WHAT HAPPENED	SOURCES
Dubai becomes the world's busiest hub in 2015	April 2013	2015	Dubai International passed Heathrow on international passengers in the 12 months to September 2014, about a year earlier than forecast.	AIN Online, 2013; TravelPulse, 2015
Middle East air traffic to grow 2.5% in 2020 with a regional airline loss of $1 billion	December 2019	2020	The pandemic overturned the forecast; by October 2020 IATA expected Middle East passenger numbers at only 30% of 2019 levels.	International Air Transport Association (IATA), 2019; International Air Transport Association (IATA), 2020

2. The shocks that changed course

Events that stopped, delayed or redirected transport plans. They are the first place to look when thinking about wild cards: each one was a surprise at the time.

APRIL 2013

Civil Defence directive cancels Hamad International Airport opening. The opening of Doha's new airport was cancelled hours before it was due and slipped by more than a year. The Peninsula, 2013; Gulf Times, 2014

SEPTEMBER 2014

Oil price collapse of 2014-16 and the Gulf budget cuts that followed. Rail and metro projects across the GCC were slowed, phased or suspended, including the GCC Railway, Oman Rail, Etihad Rail stage 2 and the Jeddah Metro. Al Jarida (Kuwait), 2016; Oxford Business Group, 2019; Oxford Business Group, 2016

AUGUST 2015

UAE retail fuel price deregulation. Linked UAE pump prices to global markets with monthly resets, framed as a way to curb fuel consumption. UAE Cabinet, 2015

JUNE 2017

Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Bahrain and Egypt cut ties and transport links with Qatar. Qatar Airways lost access to 18 cities and rerouted over Iran, Turkey and Oman; Qatar rerouted trade the same way and leaned on the new Hamad Port and direct shipping lines, opening the port formally three months into the crisis. The already stalled Qatar-Bahrain causeway was frozen. Links reopened in January 2021 after the AlUla Declaration. Al Jazeera Centre for Studies, 2017; Oxford Business Group, 2019; Aviation International News (AIN), 2017; Al Jazeera, 2017

JULY 2017

Etihad's equity alliance strategy collapses into large write-downs. Etihad posted a $1.87bn 2016 loss, mostly aircraft impairments and exposure to Alitalia and AirBerlin, and began restructuring. MEED, 2017

JANUARY 2018

Saudi January 2018 gasoline price rise. Raised Saudi gasoline to 1.37 and 2.04 riyals per litre, a large step up in the cost of private car use. Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2017

2019

DXB southern runway closure, Jet Airways bankruptcy and Boeing 737 Max grounding. DXB passengers fell 3.1% to 86.4 million and cargo fell 4.8% in 2019. Dubai Airports, 2020

MARCH 2019

Uber agrees to buy Careem for $3.1 billion. Consolidated GCC ride-hailing under one global platform, which later became the channel for robotaxi launches in Abu Dhabi and Dubai. Wamda, 2019; Uber Technologies, 2024

SEPTEMBER 2019

Fire at the Haramain Jeddah station. Gutted a flagship station one year into commercial operations and injured at least 10 people. MEED, 2019

MARCH 2020

COVID-19 pandemic and the 2020 oil price crash. Passenger transport was suspended or collapsed: air travel and transit ridership fell sharply, and governments cut capital budgets. Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2020; Emarat Al Youm, 2021; World Bank Blogs (PPPs), 2023; World Bank, 2020

JULY 2021

2021 global fuel price spike and GCC price caps. Saudi Arabia and Oman froze pump prices, pausing market-linked pricing and weakening the price signal for demand restraint. Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2021

JANUARY 2023

Kuwait scraps its $20bn metro project. Removed Kuwait's main urban rail plan on financial grounds, leaving national rail at consultancy stage. Oxford Business Group, 2024

OCTOBER 2023

Gaza war after 7 October 2023 and the 2026 war with Iran. IMEC was left effectively on hold with no firm funding or construction timelines, and the Strait of Hormuz route was disrupted in 2026. Middle East Institute, 2026

DECEMBER 2023

Houthi attacks on Red Sea shipping. Suez Canal trade fell 42% in two months and container rates more than doubled; Saudi Red Sea ports lost traffic (King Abdullah

Port down over 80% in 2024) while Jebel Ali reached its highest volume since 2015. UNCTAD, 2024

DECEMBER 2023

Hyperloop One shuts down. Ended the company behind the Dubai to Abu Dhabi hyperloop promise, with DP World keeping the intellectual property. AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight), 2023

APRIL 2024

Saudi Arabia scales back The Line's 2030 scope. Cut the showcase car-free, high-speed linear transit concept to 2.4 km by 2030, shrinking the largest planned GCC test bed for new mobility. AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight), 2024

DECEMBER 2024

GM ends Cruise robotaxi development. Removed the partner behind Dubai's plan for 4,000 Cruise robotaxis by 2030; Dubai moved to Chinese operators Baidu Apollo Go and WeRide. Al Etihad, 2021; Khaleej Times (Reuters), 2024

3. Fixed reference points

The plans, laws, targets and long-run figures later deliverables will measure change against.

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Data series	DXB handled 86,396,757 passengers in 2019 (down 3.1%) and 2,514,918 tonnes of cargo (down 4.8%), citing a 45-day runway closure, the Jet Airways bankruptcy and the 737 Max grounding.	AE	Dubai Airports, 2020
Data series	Dubai RTA reported about 346 million riders across metro, tram, bus, marine, e-hail, smart rental and taxi in 2020, about 947,000 a day.	AE	Emarat Al Youm, 2021
Data series	Dubai had 25,929 EVs at end-2023, the UAE about 2,000 public charging points, and the national goal is now 50% electric and hybrid vehicles by 2050, with EVs forecast above 15% of sales by 2030.	AE	PwC Middle East, 2024

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Data series	DXB handled 92.3 million passengers in 2024, beating the 2018 record of 89.1 million, and 2.2 million tonnes of cargo, and expects to reach 100 million annual guests by 2027.	AE	Government of Dubai Media Office, 2025
Data series	EVs are just over 1% of Saudi car sales against a goal of 30% of Riyadh's cars being electric by 2030, with EVIQ planning 5,000 fast chargers at 1,000 sites by 2030.	SA	CNN, 2025
Data series	GCC-Stat estimated the GCC population at 62.8 million in 2025, up from 56.6 million in 2022, and projected about 83.6 million by 2050.	GCC	Qatar Tribune (QNA, citing GCC-Stat), 2026
Data series	Dubai's robotaxis have covered over 4 million km and 7,613 customer trips, with 144 vehicles of which 48 are in actual operation, about 50 trips a day and 97% satisfaction, against the goal of 25% of trips autonomous by 2030.	AE	Dubai Media Office, 2026
Law or regulation	The Ministry of Energy announced gasoline and diesel prices would be deregulated from 1 August 2015, with a monthly committee setting prices on the 28th of each month in line with global prices.	AE	UAE Cabinet, 2015
Law or regulation	The Saudi cabinet raised higher-grade petrol from 0.60 to 0.90 riyals per litre and lower-grade petrol from 0.45 to 0.75 riyals, alongside the 2016 budget.	SA	Ahram Online, 2015
Law or regulation	Bahrain raised pump prices by up to 60% and Oman said it would cut subsidies and raise premium gasoline prices by 33%.	BH	Al Arabiya English, 2016
Law or regulation	Kuwait's petrol price rise took effect the next day, with premium at 85 fils per litre and the higher grade at 105 fils per litre, and KNPC expected consumption patterns to change.	KW	Al Jarida (Kuwait), 2016

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Law or regulation	Text of the royal order applying the traffic law, including driving licences, equally to men and women, with a committee to report within 30 days and implementation from 10/10/1439 AH (June 2018).	SA	Okaz, 2017
Law or regulation	The Saudi energy ministry set new gasoline prices of 1.37 riyals per litre for 91 and 2.04 riyals for 95, effective from midnight on 1 January 2018.	SA	Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2017
Law or regulation	A royal directive capped domestic gasoline prices at 2.18 riyals for 91 and 2.33 riyals for 95 from 10 July 2021.	SA	Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2021
Law or regulation	A royal directive capped Omani fuel prices at October 2021 rates (229 baisas for M91, 239 for M95, 258 for diesel) with the government absorbing losses to end-2022.	OM	Oman Observer, 2021
Plan or strategy	Announcing the Abu Dhabi Surface Transport Master Plan 2030, Department of Transport officials said the first phases of both the Abu Dhabi tram and the Abu Dhabi metro would be completed by 2015.	AE	Khaleej Times, 2009
Plan or strategy	The Saudi Railway Company was given the long-delayed 950 km, $7bn Landbridge after a tender running since 2008 (re-tendered on a BOT basis in 2009) failed, with work expected to move ahead around end 2012 or early 2013.	SA	MEED, 2012
Plan or strategy	Saudi Arabia announced NEOM, a $500 billion city served by driverless vehicles with transport solutions from automated driving to passenger drones, with a first phase due by 2025.	SA	Dezeen, 2017
Plan or strategy	New Kuwait 2035 includes an infrastructure pillar to re-establish Kuwait as a regional commercial centre, but the 171 km Kuwait Metro has been delayed by economic downturns and GCC rail progress has stalled.	KW	Oxford Business Group, 2019

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Plan or strategy	The Crown Prince launched The Line, a 170 km city for a million people with zero cars, zero streets and no journey longer than 20 minutes.	SA	Saudi Press Agency (SPA), 2021
Plan or strategy	Bahrain's government approved the start of the metro first phase, a 28.6 km elevated two line corridor with 20 stations, to be tendered as a 35 year PPP with price bidding expected from November 2021.	BH	Asharq Al-Awsat, 2021
Plan or strategy	The ministry magazine sets out National Transport and Logistics Strategy goals: a top 10 Logistics Performance Index ranking by 2030, more than 60 logistics zones, and re-export revenue rising from 42 to 520 billion riyals; it describes a 1,300 km Jeddah to Dammam land bridge for 3 million passengers and 50 million tons of freight a year.	SA	Ministry of Transport and Logistic Services (Saudi Arabia), 2021
Plan or strategy	Dubai approved an AED128 billion terminal at Al Maktoum International with capacity up to 260 million passengers, 400 gates and five runways, first phase ready within 10 years, with all DXB operations moving there in coming years.	AE	Government of Dubai Media Office, 2024
Target	At the March 2006 groundbreaking, the Red Line was due to be ready by September 2009 and the Green Line operational by March 2010.	AE	Gulf News, 2006
Target	Abu Dhabi's Midfield Terminal, with 30 gates expandable to more than 80, was scheduled to open in November 2010 and raise airport capacity to 20 million passengers.	AE	Gulf Construction, 2007
Target	Dubai World Central airport, with six runways and capacity for 120 million passengers a year, had its completion scheduled for 2017.	AE	Executive Magazine, 2007

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Target	Phase 1 of the Al Safooh tramway (10 km, 13 stations, 11 trams) was planned to enter commercial service by 2011.	AE	Alstom, 2008
Target	A Vinci-led consortium signed a USD3 billion contract for a 40 km Qatar to Bahrain causeway, with works to start after nine months of studies and finish within 51 months.	GCC	VINCI, 2008
Target	Masdar City, due to be completed in 2016, was to have a personal rapid transit system with stations throughout the city in place of cars.	AE	Technology Review (MIT), 2009
Target	Saudi Railway Organization president Abdul Aziz Al-Hoqail said the Haramain railway would be completed by mid-2012, with six months of pilot operations before an official launch in November 2012.	SA	Arab News, 2009
Target	The 18.1 km Al Mashaaer metro would open for the November 2010 Hajj at 35% capacity and reach full capacity of 72,000 passengers per direction per hour for the 2011 Hajj.	SA	Railway Gazette International, 2009
Target	Union Railway expected the Abu Dhabi first phase to be finished between 2013 and 2014 and the 1,100 km national network by 2017, at an estimated cost of about Dh30 billion.	AE	Al Ittihad, 2009
Target	Qatari authorities wanted to finish the first phase of the New Doha Port project in 2014.	QA	MEED, 2010
Target	Kuwait's new passenger terminal (Terminal 2) was anticipated to be complete by November 2016 with capacity of 13 million passengers a year.	KW	Airport Technology, 2010
Target	The first phase of Khalifa Port at Taweelah was to become operational in 2012 with capacity of 2 million TEU and 8 million tonnes of general cargo.	AE	The National, 2010

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Target	Al Maktoum International Airport at Dubai World Central planned to start passenger operations in March 2011, after opening for cargo in June 2010.	AE	CAPA Centre for Aviation, 2010
Target	Oman awarded the USD1.8bn contract for the new Muscat International Airport passenger terminal, with completion stated for the third quarter of 2014.	OM	CAPA Centre for Aviation, 2010
Target	GACA awarded Saudi Binladin Group a three-year project to add a 670,000 sq m terminal at King Abdulaziz International Airport, raising capacity to 30 million passengers a year from 17 million.	SA	Aviation Week (Times Aerospace), 2010
Target	Oman expected the first rail operations, on the Sohar-Muscat route, to begin by 2017, with the Oman-UAE link also expected around 2017 and the rest of the network taking longer.	OM	Oxford Business Group, 2011
Target	Salalah's new 71,000 sq m terminal for one million passengers a year had a 30-month build and the upgraded airport was expected to be operational around 2014.	OM	Aviation Week (Times Aerospace), 2011
Target	GCC Secretary-General Abdul Rahman Al Attiya, reading the progress report after the 31st GCC Summit, said the inter-GCC rail network would be completed by the end of 2017.	GCC	Khaleej Times, 2011
Target	Plans called for the Mubarak al-Kabeer port on Bubiyan Island to start operating with 2 million TEU capacity in 2016.	KW	MEED, 2011
Target	The IFC-advised PPP for Madinah airport set out expanding facilities to handle up to eight million passengers a year by 2015.	SA	International Finance Corporation (IFC), 2012
Target	Passenger stations on the North-South railway were under construction and due by 2014, in time for the expected start of passenger operations.	SA	MEED, 2012

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Target	The new Doha International Airport was targeting an official opening on 12 December 2012.	QA	Business Travel News Europe, 2012
Target	The Partnerships Technical Bureau expected the Kuwait metro to begin operating by 2020, with construction in five phases starting in 2013.	KW	Oxford Business Group, 2012
Target	The Dubai Water Canal, costing about AED 2 billion, was to have all construction works completed by 2017.	AE	Khaleej Times, 2013
Target	Qatar Rail's CEO said the first stage of the Doha Metro was expected to finish in 2019, after more than QR30bn of contracts were signed in May 2013.	QA	The Peninsula, 2013
Target	The $22.5bn Riyadh Metro, with contracts awarded to three consortiums in July 2013, was due to be operational in 2019 with 176 km and 85 stations.	SA	MEED, 2013
Target	Alstom and QDVC signed the €2bn contract for a 33 km, 37-stop, four-line Lusail tram, with the first line due in 2018 and the other three in 2020.	QA	Railway Gazette International, 2014
Target	The Jeddah Metro Company CEO said the metro would be completed by 2020, with passenger service after safety testing reported for 2022.	SA	Al Arabiya English, 2014
Target	Kuwait's two-phase national railway was expected to be complete by 2018, and both it and the metro were among the first projects to be tendered under the new PPP law.	KW	MEED, 2015
Target	Phase 1 of the Makkah metro (two lines, about 45 km, 22 stations) was due in four years, with metro lines operating in 2019 and buses from 2017.	SA	Oxford Business Group, 2015

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Target	Bahrain awarded an Arabtec and TAV joint venture a $1.1 billion contract for a new terminal at Bahrain International Airport, set for completion in 2019.	BH	Engineering News-Record (ENR), 2016
Target	Dubai's ruler set a goal for 25% of all car trips in the city to be driverless by 2030.	AE	The Peninsula (Associated Press), 2016
Target	The Arriyadh Development Authority set Q2 2019 as the start of commercial operations for the Riyadh bus network run by a SAPTCO subsidiary.	SA	Argaam, 2016
Target	Dubai's RTA agreed with Hyperloop One to study a Dubai to Abu Dhabi route of about 12 minutes, and the CEO said a UAE system could be built within five years.	AE	Khaleej Times, 2016
Target	Dubai's RTA said the EHang 184 single-seat passenger drone would begin regular operations in the city in July 2017.	AE	Engadget, 2017
Target	Dubai set targets for electric and hybrid cars to reach 2% of cars by 2020 and 10% by 2030, with at least 10% of new government cars electric or hybrid from 2016 to 2020 and 200 charging stations in 2018.	AE	Dubai Electricity and Water Authority (DEWA), 2017
Target	Citing KUNA, the Public Works Minister said the KD739m, 37.5 km Subiya Causeway would be completed in 2018; construction had started in 2013.	KW	MEED, 2017
Target	The RTA targeted completion of the 15 km, seven station Route 2020 in 2019, with a test run in February 2020, under a Dhs10.6bn contract awarded to the Alstom-led Expolink consortium in June 2016.	AE	Gulf Business, 2018
Target	Bahrain's transport minister said the roughly $4bn King Hamad Causeway would be tendered for consultancy in late 2018, with implementation expected to start in about two years and concession documents ready by end 2020.	BH	Al Yaum, 2018

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Target	Under Vision 2030's NIDLP, Saudi Arabia aims to move from 55th of 163 countries on the World Bank LPI in 2016 to 25th, and to raise annual exports to SR1trn by 2030.	SA	Oxford Business Group, 2020
Target	Bahrain unveiled a 109 km, four phase metro costing up to $2bn, with a 29 km first phase of two driverless lines expected to operate in 2027.	BH	Middle East Construction News, 2020
Target	Dubai said Cruise driverless taxis would start operating in limited numbers in 2023, rising to 4,000 vehicles by 2030, making Dubai Cruise's first city outside the US.	AE	Al Etihad, 2021
Target	The Saudi Ports Authority president said the national transport strategy targets port capacity of more than 40 million containers a year by 2030, against 9.5 million containers handled in 2020.	SA	Argaam, 2021
Target	PIF and Foxconn launched Ceer, the first Saudi EV brand, with cars scheduled to be on sale in 2025, US$150 million of FDI, up to 30,000 jobs and US$8 billion of GDP by 2034.	SA	Public Investment Fund (PIF), 2022
Target	The Crown Prince launched the King Salman International Airport master plan, targeting 120 million travellers by 2030 and 185 million travellers plus 3.5 million tons of cargo by 2050 on about 57 km2 with six parallel runways.	SA	Public Investment Fund (PIF), 2022
Target	Dubai targets over 42,000 electric cars by 2030 and 1,000 public charging stations by 2025, up from over 370 stations and more than 11,000 registered EV owners by May 2023.	AE	Dubai Media Office, 2023
Target	Archer and the Abu Dhabi Investment Office announced a plan to commercialise Archer's electric air taxi operations in the UAE by 2026.	AE	Archer Aviation, 2023

TYPE	WHAT IT SETS OR SHOWS	WHERE	SOURCE
Target	Joby signed a definitive agreement with Dubai's RTA giving it six years of exclusive air taxi rights, targeting initial operations as early as 2025 and service by early 2026 from DXB, Palm Jumeirah, Dubai Marina and Downtown.	AE	Joby Aviation, 2024
Target	RTA signed an MoU with Baidu Apollo Go for trials of 50 autonomous taxis, expanding to 1,000 over three years, ahead of a public launch in 2026.	AE	Gulf News, 2025
Target	GCC transport ministers reviewed progress on the GCC Railway, whose approved timetable targets completion in December 2030.	GCC	Bahrain Ministry of Transportation and Telecommunications, 2026

4. Open questions to 2035

The uncertainties that matter most, drawn from the record. They are the starting list for the programme's scenarios and System Map.

- **Oil and capital spending.** Will a third oil price shock repeat the 2016 and 2020 cuts to transport capital spending?
- **GCC Railway.** Does the December 2030 date hold when the Kuwait, Bahrain and Oman links are still at an early stage?
- **Saudi Landbridge.** How will it be financed and delivered now that the partnership model has stalled?
- **Hub airports.** Can Dubai World Central, King Salman International, Riyadh Air, Doha and Abu Dhabi all grow at once without overcapacity?
- **Airspace and sea lanes.** Will airspace closures or Red Sea disruption recur, and do the routing shifts between Red Sea and Gulf ports last?
- **Trade corridors.** Does IMEC move beyond a non-binding memorandum, and do Duqm and the Red Sea ports turn pledges into throughput?
- **Robotaxis.** Can fleets scale from about 100 vehicles to thousands, and how far will the region rely on Chinese operators as US and China technology rivalry sharpens?

- **Air taxis.** When do certified, paying passenger services start in Dubai and Abu Dhabi, and is there demand beyond showcase routes?
- **Electric vehicles.** How fast does uptake rise from about 1% of Saudi car sales, and do Ceer, Lucid and the charging networks keep pace with the targets?
- **Public transport and the car.** Do Riyadh Metro and Etihad Rail ridership shift trips away from the car, towards the 15% Saudi and 20% Riyadh public transport targets?
- **Giga-projects.** How far are NEOM and The Line cut back under fiscal pressure, and what happens to the mobility systems promised for them?
- **Fuel prices.** Do the pump price caps of 2021 stay, or does market-linked pricing resume and change how people travel?
- **Population.** How far does expatriate population growth continue, given census results below earlier estimates?
- **Kuwait and Bahrain.** Do long-standing rail and metro plans, the Bahrain Metro and the King Hamad Causeway to Saudi Arabia, turn into signed contracts?

5. How the programme uses this

- **Signal Scans** check each new development against this record, so a repeat of an old pattern is called a repeat, and something genuinely new can be called the first of its kind since a given year.
- **Change Trackers** use the base rates to judge how likely a target is to be met, rather than taking the announced date at face value.
- **Decision Intelligence briefings** draw their scenario axes and wild cards from the open questions and the shocks above, and grade new promises against how similar ones fared.
- **The System Map** starts from the cause and effect this history shows, for example oil prices driving capital spending, which drives project timetables.
- **The track record** adds each new promise to this ledger, so the record keeps growing with the programme.

This page is a reference. It records history and fixed points; current claims in later deliverables always rest on recent sources.

6. Source register

147 sources: 16 from 2006 to 2010, 31 from 2011 to 2015, 32 from 2016 to 2019, 19 from 2020 to 2022 and 49 from 2023 to 2026. Tier 1 is governments, regulators and statistics offices; Tier 2 research bodies and international institutions; Tier 3 quality journalism and trade press; Tier 4 company announcements, used only as the record of an announcement.

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
22 March 2006	Gulf News	Ground cleared for metro train ride	Tier 3	English	AE
19 July 2007	Gulf Construction	Mega airport hub	Tier 3	English	AE
13 September 2007	Executive Magazine	Dubai World Central	Tier 3	English	AE
29 April 2008	Alstom	The Dubai Al Safooh tramway is awarded to Alstom	Tier 4	English	AE
6 May 2008	VINCI	VINCI signs contract for Qatar, Bahrain causeway, the world's longest bridge	Tier 4	English	GCC
24 February 2009	Technology Review (MIT)	A Zero-Emissions City in the Desert	Tier 3	English	AE
5 March 2009	Arab News	Makkah-Madinah railway project contract signed	Tier 3	English	SA
4 April 2009	Khaleej Times	Rail Transport Key to Abu Dhabi Plan	Tier 3	English	AE
24 June 2009	Railway Gazette International	Makkah metro contracts signed	Tier 3	English	SA
13 October 2009	Al Ittihad	النوبس: طرح مناقصات مشروع قطار الاتحاد أوائل 2010 والتنفيذ يبدأ نهاية العام المقبل	Tier 3	Arabic	AE

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
24 February 2010	MEED	Doha extends closing date for port bids	Tier 3	English	QA
28 February 2010	Airport Technology	Kuwait International Airport	Tier 3	English	KW
15 March 2010	The National	Abu Dhabi's port projects on track	Tier 3	English	AE
4 June 2010	CAPA Centre for Aviation	Al Maktoum Airport plans Mar-2011 launch for passenger services	Tier 3	English	AE
28 October 2010	CAPA Centre for Aviation	Oman awards USD1.8bn new Muscat terminal project	Tier 3	English	OM
18 November 2010	Aviation Week (Times Aerospace)	Binladin Group win contract to build new terminal in Jeddah	Tier 3	English	SA
24 February 2011	Oxford Business Group	Oman: On track	Tier 2	English	OM
28 March 2011	Aviation Week (Times Aerospace)	Formal go-ahead given for Salalah Airport development	Tier 3	English	OM
10 April 2011	Khaleej Times	Inter-GCC rail network by 2017	Tier 3	English	GCC
3 May 2011	Dubai Airports (media centre)	Dubai Airports projects rapid growth to 2020	Tier 4	English	AE
2 November 2011	MEED	MEED Kuwait conference told dredging contracts for Bubiyan port to be tendered in 2012	Tier 3	English	KW

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
27 November 2011	Railway Technology	GCC to spend $79bn on rail projects	Tier 3	English	GCC
January 2012	International Finance Corporation (IFC)	Saudi Arabia: Medinah Airport	Tier 2	English	SA
9 January 2012	MEED	Saudi Railway Company to build $7bn Saudi Landbridge	Tier 3	English	SA
12 January 2012	MEED	Contract awarded for passenger stations on Saudi North-South minerals railway	Tier 3	English	SA
2 May 2012	Business Travel News Europe	Doha's new airport set to open in December	Tier 3	English	QA
10 May 2012	Oxford Business Group	Kuwait: Laying track for growth	Tier 2	English	KW
1 April 2013	The Peninsula	New airport opening postponed	Tier 3	English	QA
29 April 2013	AIN Online	Study Predicts Dubai's Preeminence by 2015	Tier 3	English	GCC
21 May 2013	Popular Science	Inside The World's Most Ambitious Eco-City	Tier 3	English	AE
1 September 2013	AD Ports Group	Khalifa Port celebrates first year	Tier 4	English	AE
2 October 2013	Khaleej Times	Mohammed launches "Dubai Water Canal"	Tier 3	English	AE

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
27 October 2013	Dubai Airports	Al Maktoum International at Dubai World Central Opens for Passengers	Tier 4	English	AE
5 November 2013	The Peninsula	Integrated railway project on track	Tier 3	English	QA
7 November 2013	MEED	Riyadh Metro	Tier 3	English	SA
27 May 2014	Gulf Times	Full operations transfer to HIA from today	Tier 3	English	QA
24 June 2014	Railway Gazette International	Lusail tram contract signed	Tier 3	English	QA
10 August 2014	Al Arabiya English	Jeddah Metro project will be ready by 2020	Tier 3	English	SA
11 November 2014	Al Bayan	ترام دبي مشروع ضخم بعشرات التفاصيل بستقبل الجمهور فجر اليوم	Tier 3	Arabic	AE
13 January 2015	TravelPulse	Dubai Passes Heathrow as World's Busiest Airport	Tier 3	English	AE
2 February 2015	MEED	Kuwait rail projects transferred to PPP body	Tier 3	English	KW
16 April 2015	Oxford Business Group	Linking up the region: Significant rail investment in the GCC should help to boost trade	Tier 2	English	GCC

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
22 April 2015	Oxford Business Group	Moving the masses: The new metro is set to transform the city's public transport	Tier 2	English	SA
21 June 2015	Aviation Week (Routes)	'New' Salalah International Airport Opens its Doors	Tier 3	English	OM
23 July 2015	UAE Cabinet	Fuel Prices to be deregulated with effect from 1 August, 2015	Tier 1	English	AE
23 September 2015	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	حج / قطار المشاعر .. " معجزة هندسية " في تاريخ بناء السكك الحديدية العالمية	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
28 December 2015	Ahram Online	Saudi to boost petrol prices by more than 50%	Tier 3	English	SA
12 January 2016	Al Arabiya English	Bahrain, Oman cut petrol subsidies as oil hits 12-year low	Tier 3	English	BH
28 January 2016	Engineering News-Record (ENR)	Bahrain Picks TAV-Arabtech for $1.1-Billion Airport Terminal Job	Tier 3	English	BH
1 February 2016	Oxford Business Group	Oman's rail strategy gathers steam	Tier 2	English	OM
25 April 2016	The Peninsula (Associated Press)	Dubai wants 25 percent of all car trips driverless by 2030	Tier 3	English	AE
31 August 2016	Al Jarida (Kuwait)	زيادة أسعار البنزين تبدأ غداً.. و«البترول الوطنية» تتوقع تغير نمط الاستهلاك	Tier 3	Arabic	KW

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
26 October 2016	Argaam	SAPTCO subsidiary to operate Riyadh bus network in Q2-2019	Tier 3	English	SA
8 November 2016	Khaleej Times	WATCH: Worlds FIRST Hyperloop will take you from Dubai-Abu Dhabi in 12 minutes, RTA signs deal	Tier 3	English	AE
9 November 2016	Dubai Protocol Department	Mohammed bin Rashid inaugurates the Dubai Water Canal	Tier 1	English	AE
13 February 2017	Engadget	Passenger drones will begin flying over Dubai this summer	Tier 3	English	AE
8 March 2017	MEED	Abu Dhabi reactivates rail schemes	Tier 3	English	AE
5 June 2017	Aviation International News (AIN)	Gulf Diplomatic Crisis Blocks Qatar's Aircraft from Airspace	Tier 3	English	QA
27 July 2017	MEED	Abu Dhabi's Etihad Airways reports close to $2bn loss in 2016	Tier 3	English	AE
13 September 2017	Al Jazeera	Qatari flight paths rerouted by Gulf crisis	Tier 3	English	QA

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
24 September 2017	Dubai Electricity and Water Authority (DEWA)	Supreme Council of Energy announces incentives to encourage community to use electric and hybrid vehicles	Tier 1	English	AE
26 September 2017	Okaz	صدور أمر سام بالسماح للمرأة بقيادة السيارة	Tier 3	Arabic	SA
18 October 2017	Al Jazeera Centre for Studies	توسعة ميناء حمد في قطر: التداعيات الاقتصادية والجيوبوليتيكية	Tier 2	Arabic	QA
23 October 2017	MEED	Kuwait to complete Subiya Causeway in 2018	Tier 3	English	KW
27 October 2017	Dezeen	Saudi Arabia to invest $500 billion in fully automated city spanning three countries	Tier 3	English	SA
22 November 2017	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	عام / أمير منطقة حائل يفتتح محطة قطار " سار " للركاب في حائل ويقوم بالرحلة الأولى على متن القطار	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
31 December 2017	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	اقتصادي / وزارة الطاقة والصناعة والثروة المعدنية توضح آلية تطبيق أسعار المشتقات النفطية المحلية الجديدة	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
11 March 2018	Gulf Business	Dubai's Route 2020 metro project on track for completion in 2019, RTA	Tier 3	English	AE

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
15 April 2018	Daily Mirror Business (bizenglish.adaderana.lk), Oman Air release	Oman Air starts operations from the new Passenger Terminal at Muscat International Airport	Tier 4	English	OM
24 June 2018	Associated Press (via Bangor Daily News)	Saudi women take the wheel as longstanding driving ban ends	Tier 3	English	SA
24 September 2018	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	عام / خادم الحرمين الشريفين يرعى غدًا حفل تدشين قطار الحرمين السريع	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
25 September 2018	Argaam	King Salman launches Haramain high-speed rail linking holy cities	Tier 3	English	SA
3 October 2018	Al Yaum	آل خليفة: حسر الملك حمد يعزز علاقتنا الراسخة بالسعودية	Tier 3	Arabic	BH
26 March 2019	Wamda	Uber confirms Careem acquisition for $3.1 billion	Tier 3	English	GCC
1 April 2019	Oxford Business Group	Hamad Port expansion in Qatar enters second phase	Tier 2	English	QA
7 May 2019	Gulf Times	Doha Metro begins service on Wednesday	Tier 3	English	QA
30 September 2019	MEED	Fire guts Jeddah high-speed railway station	Tier 3	English	SA

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
7 November 2019	Oxford Business Group	Large-scale infrastructure projects in the pipeline as Kuwait targets becoming regional transportation centre	Tier 2	English	KW
11 December 2019	International Air Transport Association (IATA)	After Challenging Year, Improvement Expected for 2020	Tier 4	English	GCC
5 February 2020	Dubai Airports	DXB retains title as #1 international airport	Tier 4	English	AE
20 March 2020	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	عام / مصدر مسؤول في وزارة الداخلية : تعليق جميع رحلات الطيران الداخلي والحافلات وسيارات الأجرة والقطارات لمدة 14 يوماً ابتداءً من الساعة السادسة صباحاً من يوم غدٍ السبت	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
5 May 2020	Oxford Business Group	Saudi Arabia leverages its strategic position to expand transport infrastructure	Tier 2	English	SA
27 June 2020	Gulf News	Jeddah airport terminal decomissioned after 40 years	Tier 3	English	SA
21 October 2020	International Air Transport Association (IATA)	IATA Revises 2020 Passenger Traffic Forecast Down for the Middle East	Tier 4	English	GCC

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
23 October 2020	World Bank	GCC Countries Outlook - October 2020	Tier 2	English	GCC
9 December 2020	Middle East Construction News	Blueprint for $2bn Bahrain metro rail unveiled	Tier 3	English	BH
10 January 2021	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	اقتصادي / سمو ولي العهد يطلق مشروع "ذا لاين" في نيوم	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
15 February 2021	Gulf News	Dubai Airports saw 25.9 million passengers in 2020, India tops in number of travellers	Tier 3	English	AE
18 February 2021	Emarat Al Youm	346 مليون راكب استخدموا «النقل الجماعي» في دبي العام الماضي	Tier 3	Arabic	AE
13 April 2021	Al Etihad	تشغيل مركبات أجرة ذاتية القيادة في دبي اعتباراً من 2023	Tier 3	Arabic	AE
1 June 2021	Khaleej Times	First look: 2 new swanky Dubai Metro stations open	Tier 3	English	AE
5 July 2021	Argaam	MAWANI eyes capacity of 40 mln containers annually by 2030: President	Tier 3	English	SA
10 July 2021	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	اقتصادي / صدور توجيه كريم بتثبيت سقف السعر المحلي للبنزين	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
20 October 2021	Asharq Al-Awsat	الموافقة على بدء مشروع «مترو البحرين»	Tier 3	Arabic	BH

DATE	PUBLISHER	TITLE	TIER	LANGUAGE	WHERE
November 2021	Ministry of Transport and Logistic Services (Saudi Arabia)	مجلة النقل، نوفمبر 2021م	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
9 November 2021	Oman Observer	Ceiling on fuel prices welcomed	Tier 3	English	OM
2 November 2022	Public Investment Fund (PIF)	سمو ولي العهد يُطلق "سير" أول علامة تجارية سعودية لصناعة السيارات الكهربائية في المملكة	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
27 November 2022	Public Investment Fund (PIF)	سمو ولي العهد يطلق المخطط العام لمطار الملك سلمان الدولي في الرياض	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
15 February 2023	World Bank Blogs (PPPs)	Beyond Madinah: How a crisis reaffirmed the power of PPPs	Tier 2	English	SA
23 February 2023	Etihad Rail	His Highness Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid, Vice President and Prime Minister and Ruler of Dubai, announces the completion of the UAE National Rail Network	Tier 4	English	AE
23 February 2023	UAE Government Media Office	Mohammed bin Rashid launches operations of national rail network	Tier 1	English	AE

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12 March 2023	Public Investment Fund (PIF)	HRH Crown Prince Announces "Riyadh Air" New National Carrier to Further Expand Saudi Aviation Ecosystem Locally and Globally	Tier 1	English	SA
18 March 2023	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	عام / الهيئة الملكية لمدينة الرياض تطلق المرحلة الأولى من حافلات الرياض""	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
22 April 2023	Argaam	Saudi Arabia jumps 17 spots on 2023 logistics performance index	Tier 3	English	SA
9 July 2023	Dubai Media Office	Dubai's green mobility ambitions shift into high gear	Tier 1	English	AE
16 October 2023	Archer Aviation	Archer & Abu Dhabi Investment Office Announce Plan to Launch Archer's All-Electric Air Taxi Service Across the UAE	Tier 4	English	AE
1 November 2023	Travel Extra	SIX years late but the flight was on time, Abu Dhabi's new Terminal A finally opens	Tier 3	English	AE
19 November 2023	Al Jazeera	اتفاق قطري بحريني لإحياء مشروع الجسر البري بين البلدين	Tier 3	Arabic	GCC
22 December 2023	AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight)	Hyperloop One hits the buffers	Tier 3	English	AE

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26 January 2024	UNCTAD	Red Sea, Black Sea and Panama Canal: UNCTAD raises alarm on global trade disruptions	Tier 1	English	GCC
11 February 2024	Joby Aviation	Joby to Launch Air Taxi Service in UAE	Tier 4	English	AE
5 April 2024	Oxford Business Group	GCC rail developments strengthen trade and connectivity infrastructure	Tier 2	English	KW
7 April 2024	AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight)	Saudi Arabia scales down plans for 170km Line by 2030	Tier 3	English	SA
28 April 2024	Government of Dubai Media Office	Mohammed bin Rashid approves designs of new passenger terminal at Al Maktoum International Airport	Tier 1	English	AE
13 June 2024	PwC Middle East	eMobility Outlook 2024: UAE Edition	Tier 2	English	AE
31 August 2024	Al Rai (alraimedia.com)	وزيرة الأشغال تتفقد موقع مشروع مبنى مبارك الكبير والوفد الصيني الحكومي	Tier 3	Arabic	KW
8 September 2024	Dubai Media Office	Dubai Metro marks 15 years of transforming urban mass transit, carrying 2.4B riders across the city	Tier 1	English	AE

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27 November 2024	Saudi Press Agency (SPA)	عام / ابتداءً بتشغيل 3 مسارات تشمل الأزرق والأصفر والبنفسجي.. الهيئة الملكية لمدينة الرياض تعلن مواعيد تشغيل مسارات قطار الرياض	Tier 1	Arabic	SA
6 December 2024	Uber Technologies	Uber and WeRide Launch Autonomous Mobility Service in Abu Dhabi	Tier 4	English	AE
11 December 2024	Khaleej Times (Reuters)	GM to exit loss-making Cruise robotaxi business	Tier 3	English	AE
26 December 2024	Oxford Business Group	Bahrain and Saudi Arabia agreements boost transport projects	Tier 2	English	BH
6 January 2025	Qatar Ministry of Transport	Minister of Transport inaugurates the Turquoise Line of Lusail Tram network	Tier 1	English	QA
30 January 2025	Government of Dubai Media Office	DXB records highest annual traffic in 2024, celebrating a decade as the world's busiest international airport	Tier 1	English	AE
13 February 2025	AGBI (Arabian Gulf Business Insight)	Saudi homegrown Ceer to produce first EVs in 2026	Tier 3	English	SA

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20 April 2025	Gulf News	Dubai's RTA inks MoU with China's Baidu to launch trials of self-driving taxis in coming months	Tier 3	English	AE
3 July 2025	CNN	One of the world's top oil producers is making a push into electric vehicles	Tier 3	English	SA
19 July 2025	Hellenic Shipping News (OceanMind analysis)	How the Red Sea Crisis has impacted international shipping activity and emissions at Saudi ports	Tier 3	English	SA
21 September 2025	Ministry of Transportation and Telecommunications, Bahrain	مطار البحرين الدولي	Tier 1	Arabic	BH
26 October 2025	The Peninsula	Riyadh Air launches inaugural flight to London	Tier 3	English	SA
11 November 2025	Khaleej Times	UAE flying taxis: Archer to deliver additional aircraft in 2026, ahead of commercial launch	Tier 3	English	AE
28 December 2025	The Maritime Executive	Kuwait Contracts With Chinese Company to Build Port in Northern Gulf	Tier 3	English	KW

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5 January 2026	Bahrain Confidential	Bahrain Metro: Everything We Know About the Kingdom's Urban Mobility Plans	Tier 3	English	BH
5 January 2026	MEED	Consultant appointed for Qatar-Bahrain causeway study	Tier 3	English	GCC
15 January 2026	MEED	Saudi Arabia restarts Jeddah metro project	Tier 3	English	SA
21 January 2026	MEED	Saudi Landbridge rail scheme to be delivered by 2034	Tier 3	English	SA
23 January 2026	Gulf News	Etihad Rail freight milestone puts passenger network in focus	Tier 3	English	AE
30 March 2026	Dubai Media Office	"طرق دبي" : بدء التشغيل التجاري لخدمة التاكسي ذاتي القيادة في منطقتي أم سقيم وجميرا عبر تطبيقي "أبولو جو" و "أوبر"	Tier 1	Arabic	AE
10 May 2026	Al Rai (alraimedia.com)	المطار الجديد... يقترب من التحليق	Tier 3	Arabic	KW
18 May 2026	MEED	Saudi Arabia tenders Mecca metro design	Tier 3	English	SA
3 June 2026	Middle East Institute	The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor	Tier 2	English	GCC

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17 June 2026	Bahrain Ministry of Transportation and Telecommunications	Bahrain chairs 29th Extraordinary Meeting of GCC Transport Ministers	Tier 1	English	GCC
14 July 2026	MEED	Contractors win King Salman airport deal	Tier 3	English	SA
19 July 2026	Qatar Tribune (QNA, citing GCC-Stat)	GCC population estimated at 62.8 million in 2025: GCC-Stat	Tier 3	English	GCC
19 August 2026	Dubai Media Office	دبي تسرّع التحول نحو التنقل الذاتي مع تجاوز الرويوتاكسي 4 ملايين كيلومتر و97% رضا المتعاملين	Tier 1	Arabic	AE
16 September 2026	Gulf Daily News	Oman-UAE rail link set for trials in late 2027	Tier 3	English	OM
26 September 2026	Arabian Business	Dubai's air taxi network: Routes, locations and launch plans explained	Tier 3	English	AE
28 September 2026	Khaleej Times	UAE President rides Etihad Rail from Abu Dhabi as Sheikh Hamdan inaugurates Dubai station	Tier 3	English	AE